



Winter pruning basics for small trees and shrubs

Always work safely. If you are unsure, or the work involves ladders or larger branches, please ask a professional.

1. Good candidates for winter pruning- Many deciduous trees and shrubs once leaves have fallen.- overlong shoots that are clearly spoiling shape or causing obstruction.- Damaged, crossing or rubbing branches that are easy to reach from the ground.
2. What to leave until later- Early flowering shrubs that bloom on last year's wood (for example many spring-flowering species).- Plants that are borderline hardy – heavy winter pruning can stress them.- Anything that requires climbing, chainsaws or specialist equipment.
3. Making sensible cuts- Use sharp, clean tools and make cuts just above a bud or branch junction.- Aim to improve structure and airflow, not simply to “take everything down”.- Step back regularly to check shape from different angles.

If you'd like help deciding what can be safely pruned in your own garden, we can arrange a focused visit and leave you with a simple plan for each plant or area.